

Willie's gane to Melville Castle

March



Willie's gane to Melville Castle: This has a strong “period” feel and once I spent a good deal of time trying to locate it in early 19th century sources. In fact the earliest publication turned out to be in Harold Boulton and Annie MacLeod’s *Songs of the North* more than half a century later. Since *Songs of the North* famously contained pieces like “The Skye Boat Song” and the modern version of “The Bonnie Banks of Loch Lomond” which were unacknowledged original compositions by Boulton and MacLeod, the same may also be the case here.



Bessie Brown at her home near Banchory with some of her many piping pupils during the 1960s. Courtesy of D. C. Thomson & Co. Ltd.